



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 33

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Heat Stress Awareness in Interior Environments

OVERVIEW:

Heat-related illness is a serious and potentially fatal condition that can develop rapidly in construction workers performing physical labor in hot environments. Interior construction sites without active HVAC can reach temperatures well above 90 degrees Fahrenheit, especially in the summer months.

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Heat illness occurs along a spectrum from heat cramps, to heat exhaustion, to heat stroke. Heat cramps — muscle spasms during or after work — are the earliest warning sign that the body is becoming stressed by heat. They indicate dehydration and electrolyte loss. The correct response is to stop heavy work, move to a cool area, drink water or an electrolyte beverage, and rest until the
2. Heat exhaustion is the body's response to significant fluid and electrolyte loss combined with cardiovascular stress from heat. Signs include heavy sweating, pale or flushed skin, weakness, dizziness, nausea, and a rapid but weak pulse. The affected worker must stop work immediately, move to a cool area, lie down, and drink cool fluids. If symptoms do not improve within 30 minutes,
3. Heat stroke is a life-threatening emergency. It occurs when the body's cooling system fails and core temperature rises above 104 degrees Fahrenheit. Signs include hot, dry or moist skin, confusion, slurred speech, loss of consciousness, and seizure. Do not wait to see if symptoms improve. Call 911 immediately and begin rapid cooling — move the person to shade, remove heavy
4. Prevention is far better than treatment. Drink at least one cup of water every 15 to 20 minutes during heat-stress conditions — before you feel thirsty. Thirst is a late indicator of dehydration. Schedule the heaviest physical work for early morning when temperatures are lower. Acclimatize new crew members gradually over 7 to 14 days in hot conditions — the body needs time to adapt its

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is the temperature forecast for this week, and what is our heat management plan for hot days?
Q2: Where is the nearest cool rest area on this job site, and do we have adequate water supply for the crew?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Drink water every 15-20 minutes — do not wait until you are thirsty
- Recognize heat exhaustion: heavy sweating, weakness, nausea, pale skin
- Heat stroke is a medical emergency: hot dry skin, confusion, loss of consciousness
- Schedule heavy physical work during cooler morning hours when possible
- Acclimatize new crew members gradually over 7-14 days in hot conditions

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 33

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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